

Thio Wachira

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Nairobi, Kenya

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Commercial builder who translates operational bottlenecks into named hires, not campaigns. Nine years carrying enterprise revenue targets - \$1M+ monthly, \$15M+ annually - across Kenya's largest advertiser relationships (Coca-Cola, Safaricom, MultiChoice DSTV, Shell). Then co-founded a two-sided marketplace from zero supply, zero demand, and no brand trust to borrow. AI-native operator - proactive daily use of Claude Code, Codex, and Antigravity, plus production workflows on WhatsApp and Twilio, the same messaging-channel layer enterprise AI vendors build on. The repo linked above is the proof: built specifically for this application, live before the interview even happens.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Enterprise Account Management

Consultative / Job-Based Selling

Market Entry & Cold-Start GTM

Senior Stakeholder Relationships

Revenue & P&L Ownership

Pricing & Commercial Model Design

WhatsApp / Messaging-Channel Commerce

Agentic AI Systems (Build, Not Just Use)

AI-Native Workflows: Claude Code, Codex, Antigravity

WORK EXPERIENCE

Standard Group PLC Oct 2019 - Mar 2022

Commercial Manager

Revenue Leadership - Nairobi, Kenya

- Owned \$1M in monthly revenue and was accountable for \$15M+ in annual revenue targets through commercial team leadership across digital and traditional media channels
- Led advertiser acquisition, retention, and upsell programs - full commercial cycle from first conversation to renewal, translating each advertiser's business problem into a specific commercial package, not a generic media buy
- Built performance tracking systems to monitor sales pipeline, yield, and advertiser retention rates

Royal Media Services (Radio CitizenFM) Jan 2018 - Oct 2019

Business Manager

Radio Revenue - Nairobi, Kenya

- Owned advertising revenue for the group's flagship radio station and one regional station - \$3M ARR accountability with consistent year-over-year performance
- Defined the commercial pricing model and go-to-market for ad inventory, reframing pitches from airtime to audience reach
- Led advertiser acquisition, renewals, and pricing discussions across key commercial accounts

Standard Media Group 2013 - 2018

Account Executive, Agency Sales

Radio & Events - Nairobi, Kenya

- Managed and grew Kenya's largest agency accounts - Coca-Cola, Safaricom, MultiChoice DSTV, and Shell - across radio and live events
- Accountable for \$1M+ in annual ad sales; responsible for renewals, upsells, and end-to-end campaign delivery across major national advertisers
- Built senior relationships with marketing and commercial decision-makers at Kenya's largest enterprises - the network this application draws on directly

Find Your Drip

Feb 2024 - Feb 2026

Co-Founder and CMO

Two-Sided Marketplace - Nairobi, Kenya

- Opened a market with zero supply, zero demand, and zero brand trust - the closest analog to entering a country with no existing commercial playbook
- Solved cold-start by sequencing supply activation first, prioritizing seller utility before scaling buyer demand
- Designed a WhatsApp-first onboarding flow enabling sellers to activate supply using existing social audiences - cut time-to-first-transaction
- Defined and tracked GMV, take rate, seller activation rate, and buyer retention to guide go-to-market sequencing

Try Dovetail Brands

Apr 2022 - Present

Head of Growth

Portfolio of early-stage D2C and marketplace brands - Remote

- Designed and shipped production AI workflows on the same messaging-channel layer enterprise AI vendors build on (WhatsApp Business API, Twilio) - ICP modelling, funnel diagnostics, ad-performance automation running daily without manual intervention
- Own GMV, revenue, and unit economics targets across brands including Protein.ke and DERAC - full commercial accountability across acquisition, retention, and funnel performance
- Use AI to correlate ad performance with CRM outcomes, identifying which channels and creatives produce highest-LTV customers - commercial judgment applied at speed, not just campaign optimization
- Run CRO programs on product pages, checkout flows, and landing pages - delivered 10-20% relative conversion lifts across multiple products

RELEVANT PROJECTS

Find Your Drip - Marketplace Cold-Start Market Entry

Co-founded and opened a two-sided marketplace from zero supply, zero demand, zero brand trust - sequenced seller activation before buyer demand to solve the cold-start problem.

WhatsApp Business API, Twilio, GMV/take-rate tracking

Dovetail Agentic Growth Infrastructure Agentic AI Build

Designed and shipped production agentic workflows for ICP modelling, ad-performance correlation, and AI-driven content generation - running daily in production across a portfolio of brands, without manual intervention.

Claude Code, custom dashboards, AI-driven content pipelines

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce (BCom), Marketing - The Catholic University of Eastern Africa

2008 - 2012

GPA 3.7, Summa Cum Laude

SKILLS

Languages: English (native), Swahili (native) **CRM & Pipeline:** HubSpot, ActiveCampaign, custom pipeline tracking systems

Analytics: GA4, Mixpanel, Google Search Console **Messaging & Automation:** WhatsApp Business API, Twilio, n8n

AI-Native Tools: Claude Code, Codex, Antigravity - daily, proactive use

Agentic Workflows: ICP modelling pipelines, ad performance automation, AI-driven content generation